

Vitamin C Rich Foods

Daily Sources of Ascorbic Acid

Vitamin C, also known as ascorbic acid, is a water-soluble vitamin required for collagen synthesis, immune function, and the absorption of non-heme iron. The human body cannot make vitamin C, so it must be obtained from the diet every day.

Why Vitamin C Matters

Vitamin C supports wound healing, acts as an antioxidant, and helps maintain skin, blood vessels, and bones. It also enhances the absorption of iron from plant sources, which is particularly useful for vegetarians and vegans.

Best Food Sources

Citrus fruits are well known for their vitamin C content, but many other fruits and vegetables contain even more. Amla (Indian gooseberry) is among the richest sources. Guava, capsicum, kiwi, and strawberries are also excellent options.

Suggested Items:

- Amla - approximately 600 mg per 100 g
- Guava - approximately 230 mg per 100 g
- Yellow capsicum - approximately 180 mg per 100 g
- Kiwi - approximately 90 mg per 100 g
- Orange - approximately 50 mg per 100 g
- Strawberries - approximately 60 mg per 100 g

Food	Vitamin C (mg/100g)	Best Eaten
Amla	600	Fresh, raw
Guava	230	Fresh, raw
Capsicum	180	Raw or lightly cooked
Kiwi	90	Fresh, raw
Orange	50	Fresh, raw

Conclusion

Vitamin C is sensitive to heat and air. Eating fruits and vegetables raw, or lightly cooking them, helps preserve their vitamin C content.